11–13 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Classmates Give Each Other Birthday Gifts at Middle School?

① Last Friday a classmate turned fourteen. Her desk, by lunch-time, had quietly become an island of small boxes — a sketchbook from the back row, a pair of warm slippers from her best friend, a handmade card from our class monitor, three packs of sweets, a small plastic bear, and even one wrapped **smartwatch** from a girl who, by Sunday evening, seemed a little tired of school. On the bus home, another friend said quietly, "**My birthday is next week. What will I do?**" Her voice carried worry, not joy. That evening I began to think about this strange new habit in our class, and by the weekend I had a clear view: **middle-school students should not give each other expensive birthday gifts — the best birthday present is a handwritten card plus, at most, a small homemade gift.**

② The first reason is **unequal pockets**. In our class of 32 students, some families can give a smartwatch without a second thought; others carefully save each week to buy a new pencil case. When birthday gifts go in one direction — from many rich givers to one lucky receiver — the class slowly builds a **hidden price table**. Some students feel they cannot have their own birthday because the "right" gift costs too much. A thirteen-year-old should not have to count the money in her family's pocket before she accepts a piece of cake.

③ The second reason is **quiet competition**. Any parent or teacher who has watched a school lunchroom knows: once one student gives a 200-yuan box of chocolates, the next birthday gift will not be a 50-yuan book. It will be a 250-yuan something. The "gift" slowly turns into a **silent contest**: whose gift is biggest, whose wrapping is most beautiful, whose name is written in the largest letters on the card. A contest we never agreed to join, but cannot easily leave.

④ The third reason is **the crowd problem**. A student who gives a small homemade card when the rest of the class gives large boxes feels **judged**. A student who does not give anything at all — perhaps because her grandmother is ill or her family is moving — feels **invisible**. Neither feeling belongs in a classroom. A good classroom teaches us, slowly, that **we are seen even when we give nothing**.

⑤ Some will answer, "Why take away a happy tradition? Classmates love giving and receiving gifts!" This is fair, and I do not wish to kill the small joy of a birthday. The answer is not to ban gifts. The answer is to **change their size**. A handwritten card, a

shared song, a small group photo printed and signed by the class, a simple self-made bookmark — these gifts cost almost nothing, and they give **twice**: to the birthday classmate on the day, and to the memory of the whole class for the rest of the year.

⑥ Others say, "My parents bought the gift. It is not really my money." That is true but not complete. A gift represents the giver, and at school the giver is **you**. When the receiver thanks you, she is thanking you, not your parents. Many of us may not yet see this: middle-school is the soft, important middle place where we learn, for the first time, to stand behind our own actions with our own hands. A gift from a parent, by the hand of a child, is not yet a true friendship gift.

⑦ What, then, should a class do on a birthday? I suggest two simple customs. First, a **shared birthday card**, passed around in lesson breaks a week before, and everyone writes one honest sentence — not "happy birthday" x32, but a real memory: "I still remember the day you helped me solve that algebra question at lunch". Second, a **two-minute class song** at the start of the first lesson on the day. No wrapping, no plastic, no competition. A birthday, in this way, becomes **a class-sized gift**, not a wallet-sized gift.

⑧ My classmate's birthday was yesterday. In the morning I slipped a small card on her desk with one sentence: "The day you lent me your umbrella in October is the reason we are friends now." She did not say anything out loud when she read it, but at lunch she pushed half her apple across the table to me. I think she understood. A birthday in our Grade 8 classroom does not need to be loud, or expensive, or trending on a short-video app. It needs to be **small, honest, and fair**. That is the gift worth giving to every birthday in every class we will ever sit in.

注释： unequal 不平等的；competition 竞争；handwritten 手写的；custom 习俗；fair 公平的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main opinion?

A. Middle-school students should give each other very expensive gifts.
B. Middle-school students should not give each other expensive birthday gifts; the best birthday present is a handwritten card plus, at most, a small homemade gift.
C. Classmates should not celebrate birthdays at all.
D. Only girls should give gifts.

2. Why does the writer mention the "hidden price table" in Paragraph ②?

A. To say that gift prices should be listed publicly.
B. To show that when expensive gifts become common, students from less wealthy families feel they cannot have their own birthday; a thirteen-year-old should not have to count the family's money before accepting a piece of cake.

C. To explain how shops set prices.
D. To argue that all gifts should be the same price.

3. According to Paragraph ④, what is the "crowd problem"?

A. Too many students come to one birthday.
B. A student who gives a small homemade card when others give large boxes feels judged; a student who gives nothing feels invisible; neither feeling belongs in a classroom — a good classroom teaches us that we are seen even when we give nothing.
C. The birthday venue is too crowded.
D. Students forget whose birthday it is.

4. How does the writer answer the view "My parents bought the gift; it is not really my money"?

A. By agreeing that gifts are always bought by parents.
B. By saying that a gift represents its giver; at school, the giver is the student; a gift from a parent, by the hand of a child, is not yet a true friendship gift — middle-school is where we learn to stand behind our own actions with our own hands.
C. By saying students should never give anything.
D. By saying parents should stop buying presents.

5. Which of the following is NOT one of the writer's suggested class customs in Paragraph ⑦?

A. A shared birthday card passed around in lesson breaks, with one honest memory from each classmate.
B. A two-minute class song at the start of the first lesson on the day.
C. A group lunch paid for by the birthday student's parents.
D. No wrapping, no plastic, no competition.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末立论
【解析】核心主张直引。A、C、D 均偏。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "hidden price table ... cannot have her own birthday ... count the money"
【解析】经济不平等影响直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段论证
【解析】两种情绪问题直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑥段回应
【解析】代际 vs 朋友礼物区分。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题（否定）
【定位】第⑦段两条提议
【解析】A、B、D 均在文中；C 为付费聚餐，作者未主张。故选 C。